CONTENDERS

Location: Breckenridge, Colorado Photos: Nate Abbott

ANDY MAHRE

Age: 19
Hometown: Yakima, Washington
Currently Residing: Mammoth, California
Sponsors: K2, Sessions, Spy, Tecnica

Your dad and his twin brother [Steve and Phil Mahre] utterly dominated ski racing in the late 70s and early 80s. Did you learn to ski before you learned to walk?

Let's see … I started skiing when I was two. I'm not sure if I was walking by then or not.

Was there a lot of pressure on you to become a competitive skier?

My dad just wants me to do what I like to do and have fun. If there was any pressure to do well, it was from myself. Skiing is what I've always wanted to do, and the only way to be good is to never be satisfied with where you are.

What does your dad think about the state of skiing today, with skiers in the halfpipe and skiers on rails and such?

My dad hasn't really said too much about it. I know he likes to watch me ski. As long as I'm having fun with it, he'll be happy.

Ever challenge him to a rail jam?

Not yet. Maybe someday I'll get him to hit a box or something. I tried to get him on my Seth Pistols not too long ago, but he prefers his racing skis.

Ever wear his silver medal around to convince girls you're an Olympian?

No … but I did take it to show-and-tell when I was little. Other kids were bringing in their pet rats and stuff, and I roll in with an Olympic medal. On the way home I left it on the bus … they had to come back and drop it off at my house. I don't think he ever found out about that incident.

Goals for the winter?

I'm working with my friend on a video for penguinmilk.com, and I want my segment to be good. I've started filming with other companies, too, and I've been training harder. If I can get good comp results and have good video segments, I'll be happy.—**JF**